

Module Eight: The Essence of Communicating

Module Overview

Time: 3.5 hours

Module Objectives:

- Demonstrate the essence of communicating.
- Demonstrate that a team's experience of synergy creates breakthrough results.

Sections:

1. The Synergy Game
2. Large Group Debrief

Content:

- The Essence of Communicating

Activity: The Synergy Game

Purpose of the Activity: By working in teams to express and recognize the meaning of words that are key to the environment they collectively want to create, participants learn that the essence of communicating creates engagement and alignment. It is about working together, so that synergy and success can occur.

They'll experience:

- The ability to recognize truth versus illusion.
- The importance of non-verbal communication.
- The meaning of concepts that are key to the environment they collectively want to create.
- Genuine communication, and how it creates the team's synergy.

Module Nine: Taking Ownership for Change

Module Overview

Time: 1 hour

Module Objectives: Participants put everything they have been learning together into taking ownership for change. They:

- Assess where they and their employees, teams and larger organization are in the Model for Change.
- Assess where they and their employees, teams and larger organization are on the Ownership Curve.
- Share their visions and intentions, and align with each other as leaders and sponsors of the larger organizational change.
- Commit to owning change.

Sections:

1. Model for Change Assessment
2. Taking Ownership Assessment
3. Shared Vision and Intention
4. Action Planning

Content:

- Model for Change Assessment
- The Ownership Curve
- Shared Vision and Intention
- Creating a Concrete Measurable Plan

Activity: Assessment and Planning Activity

Purpose of the Activity: Participants assess where they and their employees, co-workers and senior managers are in the process of taking ownership for change. Participants share and align their visions and intentions as managers, and commit to taking action to improve communication and lead others in change.

They'll experience:

- Recognizing gaps between their current state and what is required to move forward.
- Thinking differently about how they can impact desired change.
- Committing to leadership in change and creating a concrete measurable plan.



The Model for a Paradigm Shift

The process of organizational paradigmatic change is not a smooth one. It includes periods of crisis and chaos. It involves political campaign, conflict, perturbations and power restructuring. Typical of this process are the call for "back to basics" and the denial or avoidance of new ideas that represent a new paradigm...

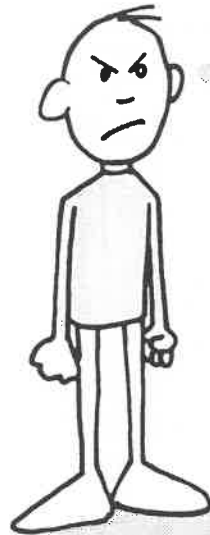
Amir Levy and Uri Merry, *Organizational Transformation*

...Yet, the experience of successfully living through the shift from a paradigm of control and hierarchical authority to one of responsibility and interdependence makes the outcome of change one of joy and excellence—something to look forward to.

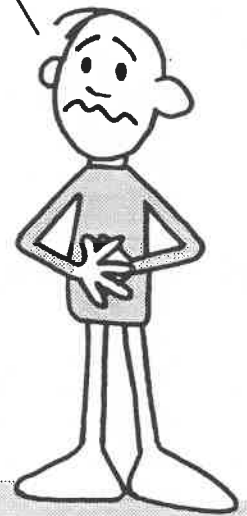
Can I get
away
without
changing?



Why
change?



How do we
change
without
going
crazy?



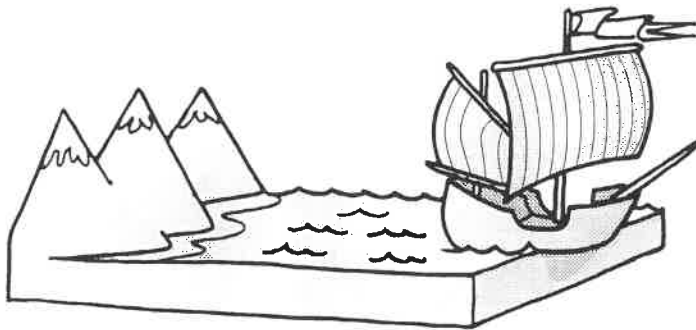
Business is the only institution that has a chance, as far as I can see, to fundamentally improve the injustice that exists in the world. But first, we will have to move through the barriers that are keeping us from being truly vision-led and capable of learning.

Edward Simon, Excerpted from *The Fifth Discipline*



Paradigm:

The basic belief and value system that dictates organizational attitudes and group behaviors.



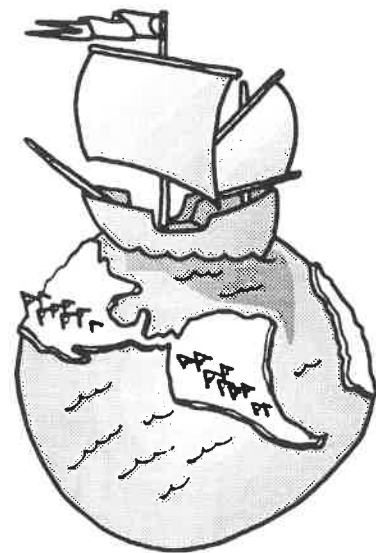
Earth is flat.



Paradigm Shift:

Drastic, hard-to-grasp change;

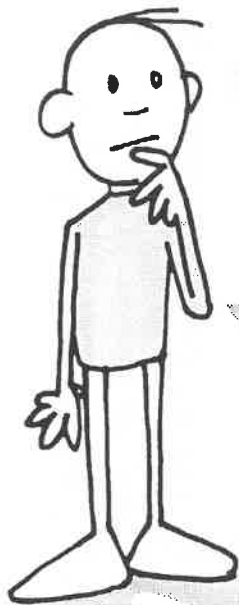
Radically innovative solutions to old as well as new problems. Not the step-by-step, tried-and-true methods of change, but whole new approaches.



Earth is round.



The Paradigm of Response-Ability:



CHOICE

CHOICE

REACTION

CHOICE

CHOICE

The ability to respond in the moment to the present situation.

EVENT

We acknowledge that we make decisions from moment to moment, whether we are conscious of it or not. As a consequence, the results we have are not random, spurious or disconnected. The way we are at every moment creates our future. We choose our responses from unlimited options—not only by the reactions demanded from our history. When we make mistakes we need to correct rather than judge.



PARADIGM OF CONTROL

Parent-Child
Dependence
Supervision
Hierarchy



No Accountability

PARADIGM OF RESPONSIBILITY

Partnership
Interdependence
Empowerment
Intrapreneurship



Accountability



When there is a paradigm shift,
people's context changes.

Context:

The environment
in which a
specific event is
experienced.

The Context of Personal Freedom:

Being the source of the
results you create, with-
out judgement.

Living from a context of personal freedom
creates breakthroughs.

Heraclitus said, "The only constant in life is change." Today, however, change is occurring at a more rapid pace than ever before. This is true in the relationships between countries, employees and employers, parents and children, or lovers and friends. These changes are happening so quickly that we need to become responsible and behave as free humans in order for success to have a chance. We can no longer blame other people for what we are feeling and for what has happened in our lives.



PURPOSE

Purpose:

The reason for which something exists or is done.

We all have a purpose, our reason for being born. Living that purpose creates joy and freedom. When we were children, we had a connection to that purpose. Some of us remember our purpose and some of us do not. Regardless, without it, it doesn't matter how much money and power we accumulate, most of us are conscious of something missing, an ache, a loneliness; and we will create crisis after crisis in an effort to find the missing piece.

My childhood purpose is:





Mission:

The purpose of the organization; the reason it exists. It encompasses the values and culture of the organization.

People need to feel that what they are doing is meaningful and important. They need to connect their work with the overall work of the organization. And they need to believe that what the company does matters to the world. This is the mission of the company, and in order to promote inspired performance, the mission needs to be more than a vague statement of values in the annual report. It needs to be felt by each worker and to be a part of the fabric of the environment.

John D. Adams, *Transforming Leadership*





Vision:

A desired future state lived in the present.
The picture of purpose brought to life.

Your Vision will inspire you in times of despair and chaos. It will be a star to steer by when you are beset by doubts. In an organization, it provides clarity and direction and allows ownership for all involved. It will be a motivating force to empower people to grow, no matter how they personally feel at any given moment, and it will keep people focused on the biggest picture possible.

Steps for Creating a Vision for Yourself (or Your Organization)

1. Connect with your (or your organization's) purpose—your (or your organization's) reason for being.
2. Picture yourself (or everyone in your organization) living that purpose right now. What would it look like?
3. Make the picture big enough so that it can include all parts of your life (or everyone in your organization).



4. Make it something you can commit to that will guide you through future obstacles and difficult times.



Objectives:

Reference points to let you know where you are in relationship to your (or your organization's) vision.

List your personal objectives which, when accomplished, will let you know you are closer.

1.

2.

3.

*When I get hair on my lip, I'll know I'm
almost grown up!*
Peter Pan



What needs to change in you and your organization to make Partners in Performance and the Aspiration Statement a reality?

Self

Organization

What behavior do you commit to change in this program:





When you
commit to
change, you
create:

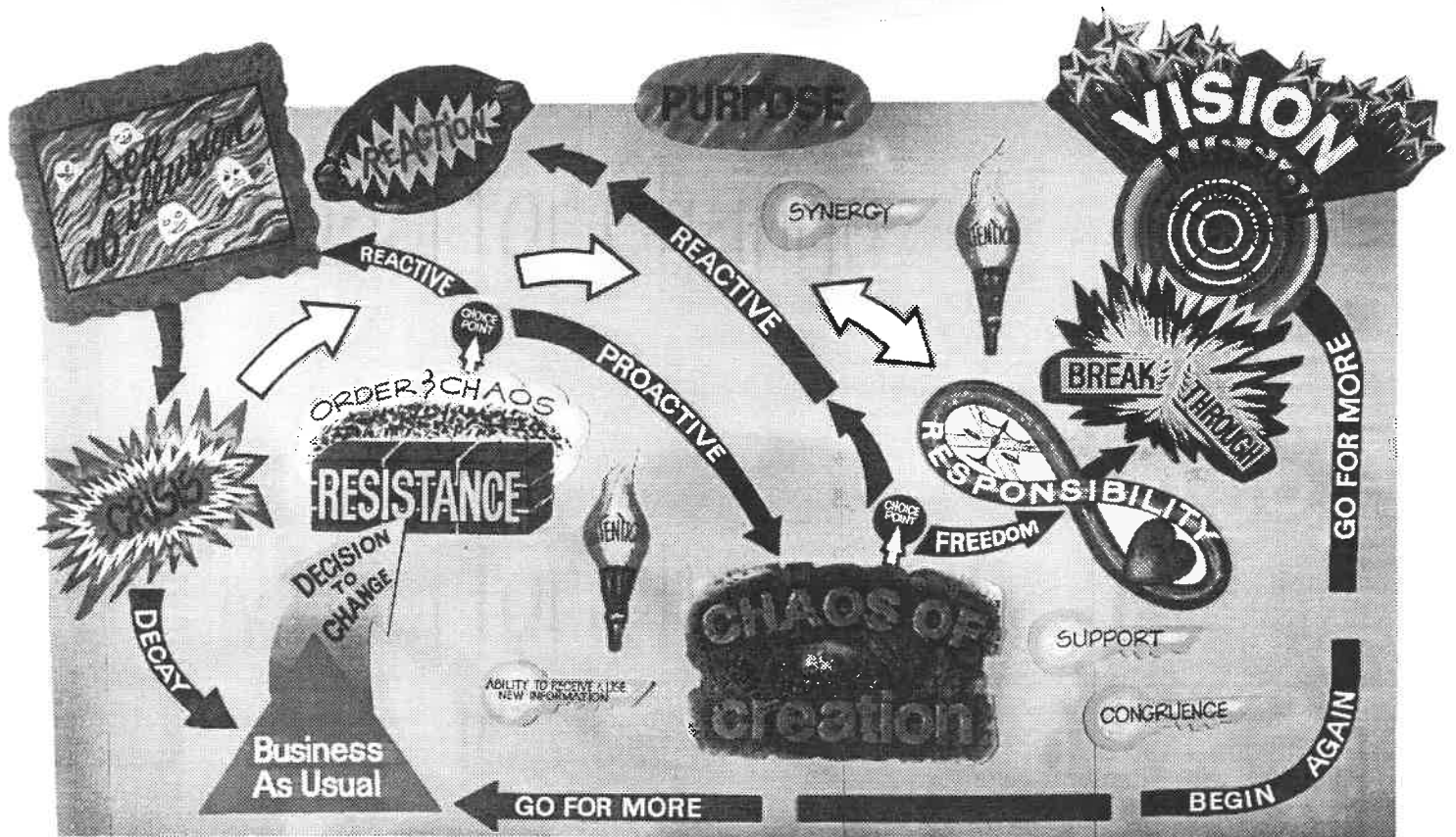
Paradox:

The state of maintaining
two seemingly opposite
experiences at once.

When we are in paradox, we feel pulled in two opposite directions—one, the life of comfort, the old familiar way of doing business, and two, the pull to our vision, a new way of being. We must be able to include the past and create the future simultaneously by the focus of our will, rather than how we feel.



The Model for Change®



There is a pattern when people experience changes in their personal behavior.

Whatever the setting, knowledge of that common pattern is essential to managing the stress of change and of channeling the energy toward successful change.

We call that pattern The Model for Change® and it consists of 10 steps.



- STEP 1. Whether it is prompted by an inner desire or an external situation, you recognize the need to change, to leave what you are familiar with—the status quo. The decision needs a clear vision, strong intention and support to carry it through.
- STEP 2. Your inner resistance to the change hits! You desire to go back to what you know. In order for resistance to occur, there must be an equal balance of order and chaos. Order represents the familiar—what was; chaos represents the new—the unknown.
- STEP 3. The interaction of order and chaos creates immense agitation. Order and chaos are neither wrong nor right and both are necessary for the change to occur.
- STEP 4. If the agitation gets strong enough, something has to give. You move to a choice point—you will go one way or the other.
- STEP 5. Choosing the past does not work. If the past was workable there would be no need to change in the first place. Choosing the past results in illusion, a self-deception. You either deceive yourself into thinking that the change was not necessary, or that you have already achieved it. Self-deception eventually erodes your self-esteem.
- STEP 6. When you choose illusion consistently, you often cannot see what you are doing. You create a crisis which can wake you up to the change you need to make. The crisis can be ignored, which leads eventually to demise; or, it can shake you up enough to recommit to the change, and mean it this time.
- STEP 7. The other option is to risk the unknown and do something new; to stay with your intention to change. This choice throws us into the chaos of creation. 'Chaos' because you are pulled in opposite directions—you are in paradox, maintaining two seemingly opposite experiences at once. 'Creation,' because when you are in the unknown, you have the space to choose new behaviors. You need to learn to be able to simultaneously acknowledge the past and create the future by staying with your decision to change.
- STEP 8. Chaos is extremely uncomfortable and leads to another choice point. At this point, strong intention and support are critical! It is easy to lose sight of your vision and fool yourself. You need the support of people who know your intention and vision and who will help you stay on track.
- STEP 9. Staying in chaos is essential to shift to the new paradigm—responsibility. You are the source of your experience and are able to receive and use new information. You change the way you see. The same data means something different than it did before. You are able to discover new solutions to old problems. You demonstrate the context of personal freedom.
- STEP 10. You are at a critical point because life doesn't feel, look, or seem familiar. It usually doesn't fit your pictures of how things are. At this point, you need to remember your decision and intention and stay congruent, using everything you have learned so far. It is okay that things don't look and feel as expected. If you continue to risk the unknown, you will have continued breakthroughs and will get closer and more connected to your vision.



1. Business as Usual

means we believe we can apply old ways to new problems or try to modify the problems to fit the old ways of solving them. But, new solutions are not possible without changing our belief systems and how we think.



3. Resistance

occurs when we want to return to the familiar because the unknown is always uncomfortable.

2. Decision to Change,

to leave the status quo. The decision is made best with a clear vision and needs strong intention and support to carry it through. It is prompted by intense pressure, either internal or external. When the pressure is external, we also need to find a personal, internal reason to make the change; otherwise, we will not do it.



It is after we decide that change is necessary that we experience our resistance.



Intention

is neutral and
aligns with our will
to carry us to our
desired results.



When the agitation from living in paradox gets strong enough, we are forced to move to a choice point. We either attempt a retreat to our history or move forward into the unknown.





Reaction:

A patterned internal response to a present situation, that stems from the past.

When the old and the new collide and we don't let go of the old to make room for the new, we have a reaction. Reaction is a loss of personal power. It is an unconscious response to a present situation based on something that happened when we were children. Because we develop patterns of behavior, we often don't recognize when the outside situation changes. We keep doing the things we always did even though they are not appropriate to or related to the present.



Reaction creates the negative parts of society that people are ashamed and afraid of...creates violence of every type....when people are not dealing with what is true, they are capable of creating any crime.

Judith Orloff, Choices for Success



Illusion:

A state or condition of deceiving oneself.

When we slide into or choose illusion, often we can't see what we're doing. Eventually, we create a crisis. This can wake us up to the fact that we need to make a change. If the crisis is ignored, decay and failure result. Or, we can be so shaken up by the crisis that we recommit to our decision to change and mean it.

Crisis:

A catastrophic situation.

危机

CRISIS AS OPPORTUNITY

(wēi jī)

The Chinese word for "crisis" is made up of two parts: "danger" and "opportunity".

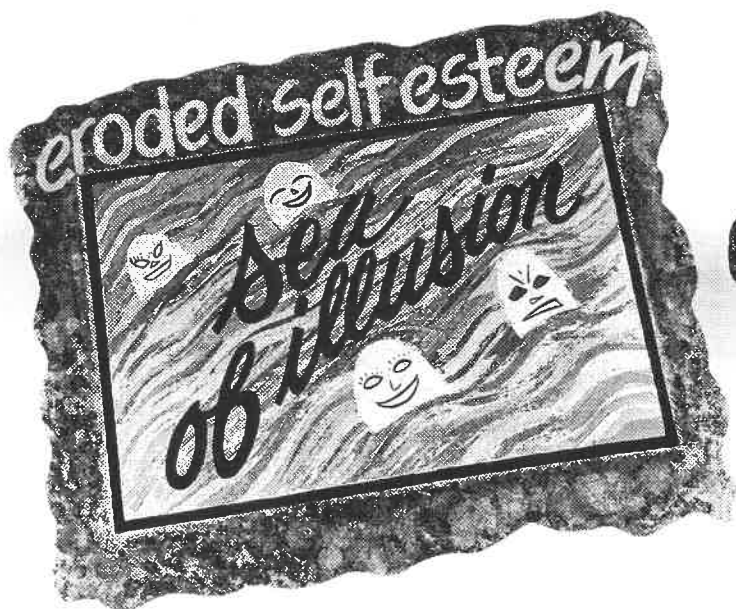
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"Danger", originally pictured as a man on the edge of a precipice 𠂇

机

"Opportunity"—a reminder of the seemingly small but important opportunity that can come out of danger.





The path to illusion, to the past, to history, to the way you've always done things, the way you were taught to behave.



The path to the vision includes being in chaos before reaching personal freedom and breakthrough.





Chaos:

Managing the old
and implementing the
new simultaneously.
This creates paradox
and conflict.

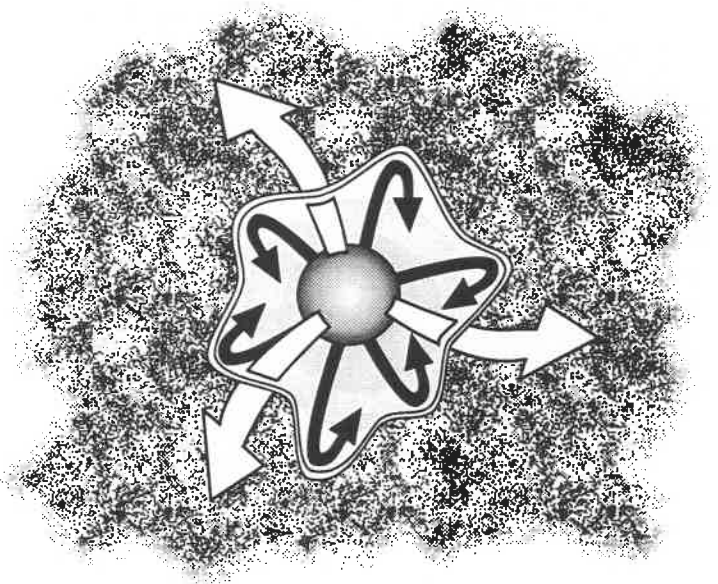
The path to vision is to risk the unknown and do something new by staying committed to our choice to change. This throws us into the Chaos of Creation. "Chaos" because we feel all the feelings that were protected by our old pattern of behavior. "Creation" because it is literally that. We are in new territory and we are choosing our reality from the raw material of our experience in the moment. Prior to experiencing chaos, real change is limited. When we choose chaos, we still have a tendency to pull toward the old and familiar. So, our vision is very important. This dual consciousness creates paradox, a very important factor in making change happen.



Perturbation:

The physical sensation that precedes the action that leads to change.

When we decide to stay with our choice, it creates a feeling of agitation. On the one hand, there is the comfort and order of the past—the old way of doing things; on the other hand is the chaos of the present—our awareness of the necessity for the new. This paradox creates perturbation.



The continuous movement of energy through the system results in fluctuations; if they are minor, the system dampens them and they do not alter its integrity. But if the fluctuations reach a critical size, they “perturb” the system. They increase the number of new interactions within it. They shake it up.
Marilyn Ferguson, *The Aquarian Conspiracy*



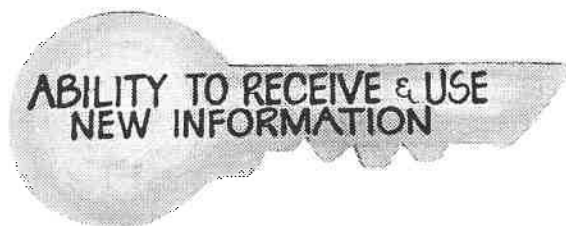
The Keys to Change:

The inner experience of chaos is very uncomfortable and is, at times, like a storm. We need others to talk with, to assist in staying true to our choices.



Support:

Telling the truth as it is: with nothing added or excluded.



Receiving and Using New Information

When we are truly open to new information, we can see new solutions to problems. Lateral thinking includes suspending judgements in order to allow new information to interact and generate new ideas.



CONGRUENCE

Congruence:

When your attitude and action are consistent with your deepest purpose; having one face.

When you are congruent, you experience self-esteem and trust.

You are capable of seeing things from a clear perspective—from a newness. You are able to model your leadership without effort.

People respect you and are empowered in your presence. You "walk your talk."

SYNERGY

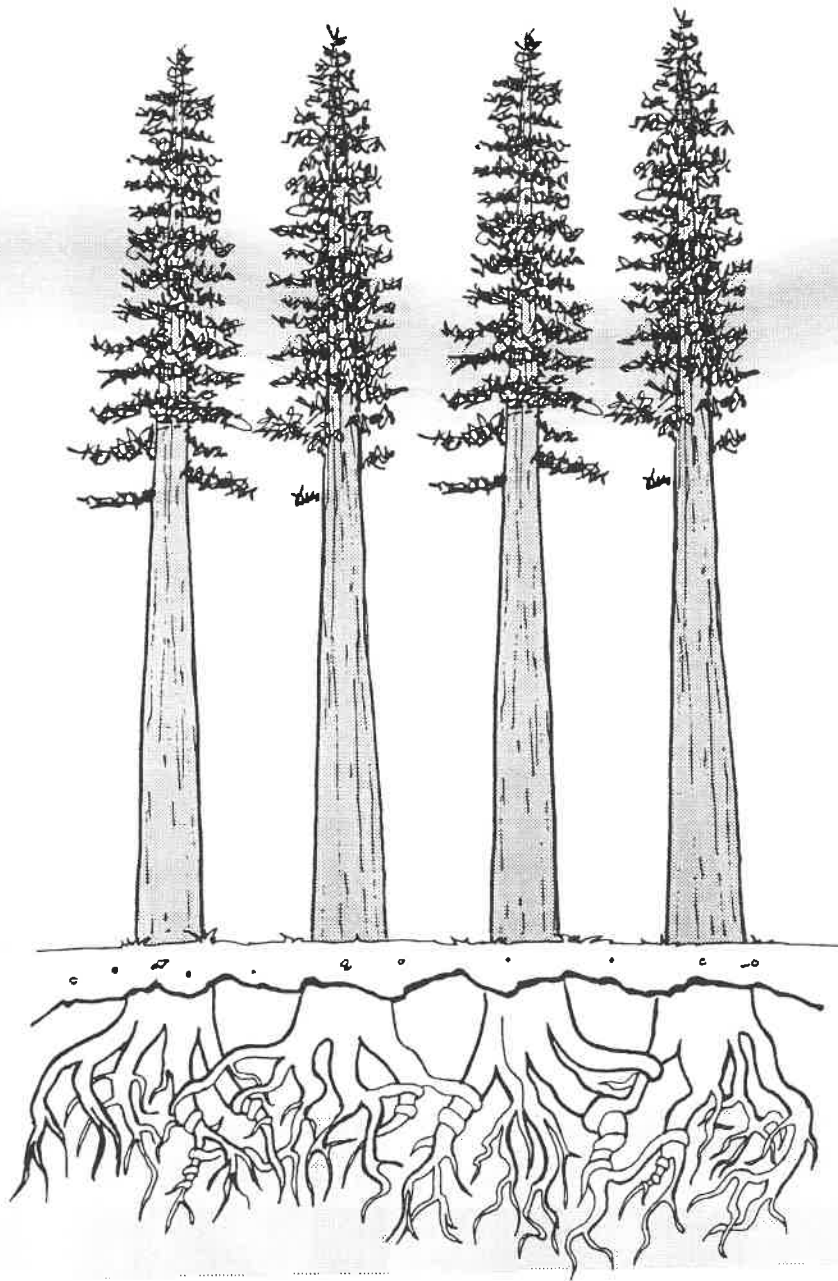
Synergy:

Energy shared multiplies

Every so often we hear of a group of people who exceed their individual skills and realize a collective energy, creating results that far surpass expectations.

When synergy is active in an organization, there is magic. In the days of old, there were wizards and alchemists, men and women who transformed lead into gold. Today we have pioneers—men and women who risk cooperation rather than play at win/lose, who own the vision and mission of the organization, and who know that their life and that of the organization are integrated.





Dependence is the paradigm of you—you take care of me; you come through for me; you didn't come through; I blame you for the results.

Independence is the paradigm of I—I can do it; I am responsible; I am self-reliant; I can choose.

Interdependence is the paradigm of we—we can do it; we can cooperate; we can combine our talents and abilities and create something greater together.

Stephen Covey, The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People



How to Create a Paradigm Shift

STEP 1. See it as necessary. If you don't see it as necessary, do not go on.

STEP 2. Choose new personal behaviors that are congruent with the new paradigm.

STEP 3. Be willing to recognize, acknowledge and correct when you revert to old behaviors (continuous improvement).

STEP 4. Be willing to embrace discomfort as it occurs, knowing it is necessary and valuable.

STEP 5. Be willing to learn.

STEP 6. Examine and share your thoughts and feelings on a regular basis, with people you trust.

STEP 7. Tell your truth.



When...

Your PURPOSE is clear...

Your MISSION is decided...

Your VISION inspires you...

Your OBJECTIVES are defined...

You DECIDE to change...

You meet your RESISTANCE...

You experience PARADOX...

Your INTENTION is strong...

You use NEW INFORMATION...

You stay through the CHAOS...

You seek SUPPORT...

You are CONGRUENT...

You are RESPONSIBLE...

You create SYNERGY...

You experience PERSONAL FREEDOM...and



to ACCOUNTABILITY
and PARTNERSHIP.

GLOSSARY

ALIGN: To converge thoughts, behaviors and courses of action into a line.

BELIEFS: Unquestioning acceptance of something as true without positive knowledge or proof, as handed down by family or environment.

BREAKTHROUGH: Movement through a barrier (which permits further progress).

CHAOS: Managing the old and implementing the new simultaneously.
This creates paradox and conflict.

COMMITMENT The state within oneself of being totally pledged to a way of being or a course of action.

CONFLICT: Discord of action, feeling or effect.

CONGRUENCE: When your attitude and action are consistent with your deepest purpose; having one face.

CONNECT: To establish communication between; to join or unite.

CONTENT: Any specific thing or event.

CONTEXT: The environment in which a specific event is experienced.

CONTEXT SHIFT: A transformation in the way life is experienced.

CONTROL: To exercise restraint or domination over.

CREATION: The act of producing or causing to exist.

CRISIS: A catastrophic event.

ENTITY: Something that has a real existence.

EQUAL: Having the same value.

EXPERIENCE: All that is perceived, understood and remembered.



FREEDOM: The power to make one's own choices without constraint from within or without.

HISTORY: The sum of past events relating to a particular person.

ILLUSION: A state or condition of deceiving oneself.

INTEGRITY: The state of being whole, entire or undiminished.

INTENTION: The strength of our will that determines results.

INTERPRET: To assign a meaning to; to construe or explain in a particular way.

LATERAL THINKING: Suspending judgements in order to allow information to interact and generate new ideas.

LEADER: One who holds a vision and empowers others; one who accepts ultimate responsibility for results.

LEARN: To acquire data, skill, and understanding.

LIVING: In actual existence or use.

MANIFEST: To bring into being.

MISSION: The purpose of the organization; the reason it exists. It encompasses the values and culture of the organization.

OBJECTIVES: Reference points to let you know where you are in relationship to your company's vision.

ORDER: The observance of prescribed procedure or behavior.

PARADIGM: The basic belief and value system that dictates organizational attitudes and group behaviors.



PARADIGM SHIFT: Drastic, hard-to-grasp change; radically innovative solutions to old as well as new problems. Not the step-by-step, tried-and-true methods of change, but whole new approaches.

PARADOX: The state of maintaining two seemingly opposite experiences at once.

PERSONAL FREEDOM: Being the source of the results you create, without judgement.

PERTURBATION: The physical sensation that precedes the action that leads to change.

PRESENT TIME: That which is now and becomes the past almost as rapidly as it is observed.

PURPOSE: The reason for which something exists or is done.

REACTION: A patterned internal response to a present situation, that stems from the past.

RESISTANCE: A force that tends to oppose or retard motion.

RESPONSIBILITY: The ability to respond in the moment to the present situation.

SUPPORT: Telling the truth as it is; with nothing added or excluded.

SURVIVAL: The behaviors that were necessary to stay alive in the circumstances of our childhood.

SYNERGY: Energy shared multiplies.

UNCONSCIOUS: The part of the mind containing psychic material of which the ego is unaware.

VISION: A desired future state lived in the present.
The picture of purpose brought to life.

WILL: Conscious choice of action or thought; the power that forms and maintains intention.



ARTICLES

